

Where can I find real photos of AI data centers, and their water cooling systems?

Posted by u/GoatsWithWigs • 0 points • 5 comments

Thematically, it's very difficult to find actual photos of LLM data centers because most pictures of them are from some bullshit AI bro blog, and it'll be this doohickey Tron-looking AI-generated neon arcade fest, but I know they don't really look like that. Starting to wonder if photos of them even exist, but they've got to, right? So, does anyone know whwre those are?

Comments

u/KingKuys2123 • 1 points • 2026-02-06 06:04 UTC

It sounds like water usage in tech is a big worry for many, but it's great to see new cooling tech stepping up. In my experience at Lifewood Data Technology, we really value these sustainable shifts because they prove that scaling AI doesn't have to come at the expense of the planet.

u/Dizzy-Anteater-3215 • 1 points • 2026-02-06 02:16 UTC

Water use from large data centers is definitely becoming an environmental concern. That said, some operators are exploring more water-efficient cooling and sustainable facility designs to reduce the impact. Even groups like Lifewood are looking at ways to make data infrastructure more responsible. It's not a perfect fix, but it's a step in the right direction

u/SlowHornet29 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 19:01 UTC

Here is an article on the immersion cooling, it's really new and I don't know of any data centers that use it yet but I'm not in the mega big data centers.

[BP Immersion Cooling for Data Centers.](<https://www.bp.com/en/global/corporate/news-and-insights/energy-in-focus/castrol-liquid-cooling-for-data-centres.html>)

u/SlowHornet29 • 2 points • 2026-01-17 18:45 UTC

I have worked in and around data centers for the last 10 years and it's always funny when they claim all the water data centers use.

It's really not much different than any other commercial building, only difference is the scale, as in a residential building doesn't create as much heat as say a data center so the cooling demands is less but it's basically the same equipment.

When you drive around a building in the winter and see steam rolling off the roof that's likely a cooling tower and they have a chiller, same as a data center.

The submersion cooling I have seen in “Data centers use so much water” ads, is a special liquid the facility buys, it’s not tap water and it doesn’t get thrown out and drained, would be that liquid running through a heat exchanger and chiller water would pick up the heat. The chiller water and that liquid don’t touch.

I have never been in a submersion cooling data center, only air cooled data centers but it’s all the same thing, just a different process.

u/North_Resident6175 • 3 points • 2026-01-17 18:35 UTC

Most big tech companies like Google, Microsoft, and Meta actually have official pages showing off their data centers - they're pretty proud of them for PR reasons. The real ones look way more boring than the sci-fi stuff, just rows and rows of black server racks in white rooms

You could also try searching for "hyperscale data center" or "cloud infrastructure" instead of AI-specific terms since they're basically the same facilities

u/ForScale • 2 points • 2026-01-17 18:34 UTC

Google.

I found this as a top result: <https://www.brookings.edu/articles/ai-data-centers-and-water/>

u/GoatsWithWigs • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:35 UTC

Now that's more like it, thanks